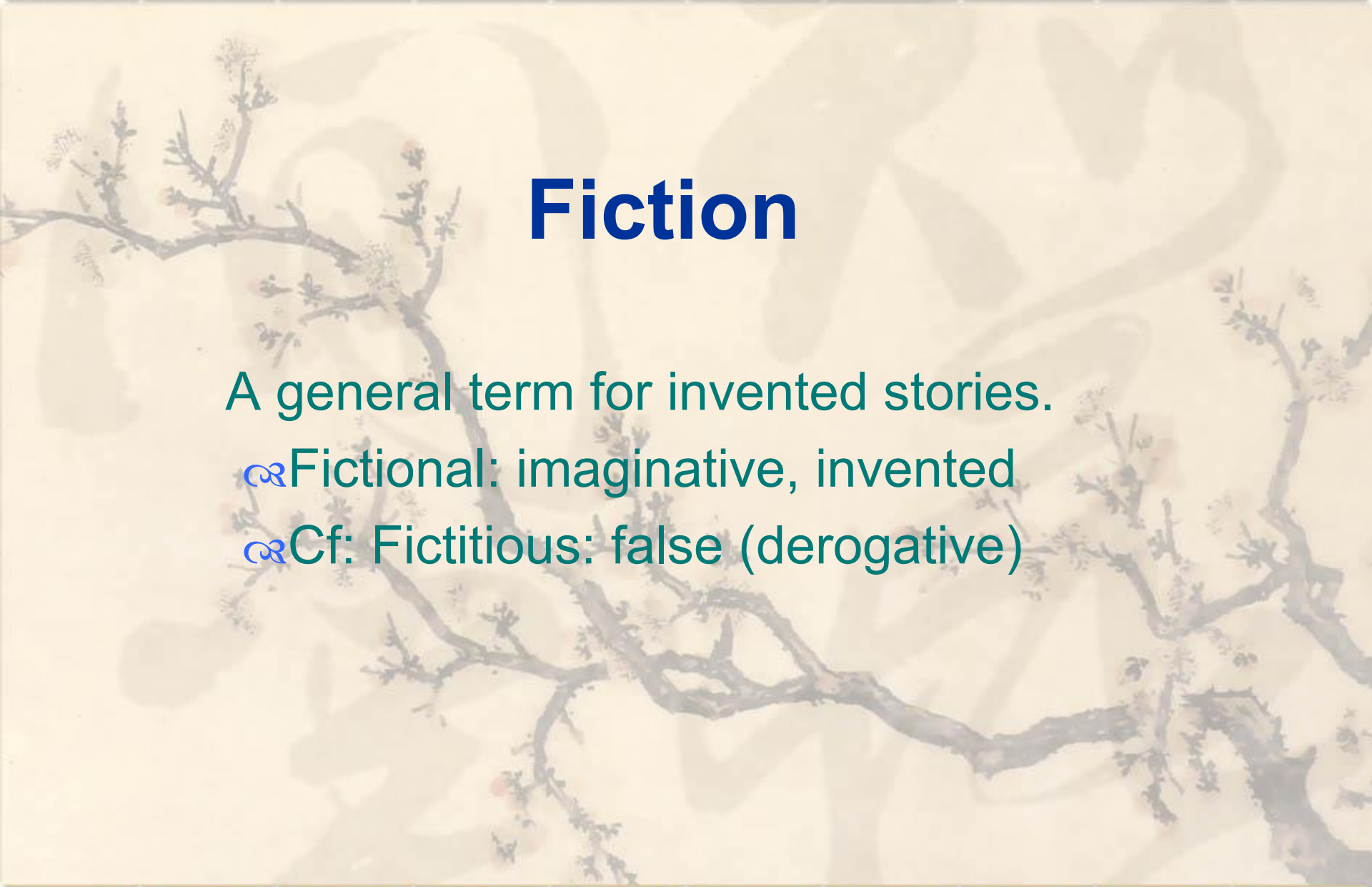




Fiction

A general term for invented stories.

∞ Fictional: imaginative, invented

∞ Cf: Fictitious: false (derogative)

Modern Fiction

- ❖ Fiction in modern sense includes short stories, novella (short novel), novel, romance, fable, and other narrative works in prose (**prose narratives** 非韵文叙事作品), in contrast to **verse narratives** (e.g. epic)

Novel

- ❖ **Novel**: an **extended prose narrative** about largely **fictional** if usually **realistic** characters and **plausible** events.
- ❖ 一种关于基本上是虚构的人物与事件，但通常读上去又显得十分真实的长篇散文体叙述。

The Rise of Novel

- ❖ **18th century** is generally acknowledged as the period of **the birth of the English novel**
- ❖ Until the 1st half of the 18th century, **prose fiction** was not considered a worthy pursuit.
- ❖ The sanctioned genres: **verse (poetry)** and **drama**.
- ❖ Forms of **Narrative** before the rise of novel:
 - ❧ 1. Verse narrative: **epic**
 - ❧ 2. Prose narrative:
 - ❖ Fictional: **romance** (传奇), **fable**, **allegory** (寓言)
 - ❖ Non-fictional: **history**, **autobiography**, **journalism**, **travel writing**

Cause: Social and Cultural Change

- ❖ The development of novel could be viewed as a literary response to profound cultural and social changes:
 - ❧ Culturally, the change in people's intellectual perception and understanding of the world: the **Enlightenment thought** that stresses **reason** and aspires for **actuality**.
 - ❧ Technologically, the development of the technology of printing, the growing market for print in the 18th-century Britain.
 - ❧ In terms of Social condition, the increase of literacy among urban populations.

The Development of English Novel in the 18th C

- ❖ 18th century is generally acknowledged as the period of **the birth of the English novel**
- ❖ First fine flush of English prose fiction:
 - ❧ ***Daniel Defoe*, Robinson Crusoe (1719), Moll Flanders (1722); *Jonathan Swift* Gulliver's Travels (1726)**
- ❖ Full flowering of the English novel:
 - ❧ 40's and 50's: Samuel Richardson's *Pamela* 《帕梅拉》, *Clarissa Harlowe*, Henry Fielding's *The History of Tome Jones, a Foundling* 《弃儿汤姆·琼斯》
 - ❧ 60's and 70's: novel of sentimentalism -- Laurence Sterne's *A Sentimental Journey* 《一缕芳魂》 and Oliver Goldsmith's *The Vicar of Wakefield* 《韦克菲尔德牧师》

Elements of Novel

❖ Elements of Drama

- Plot 情节
- Character 人物
- Thought 思想
- Diction 语言
- Music 音乐
- Spectacle 布景

❖ Elements of Novel

- Plot 情节
- Characterization 人物塑造
- Theme 主题
- Style 风格
- Point of View 视角
- Setting 背景

the most technical aspect of novels: **POV, or narrative point of view**

Narrator (叙述者)

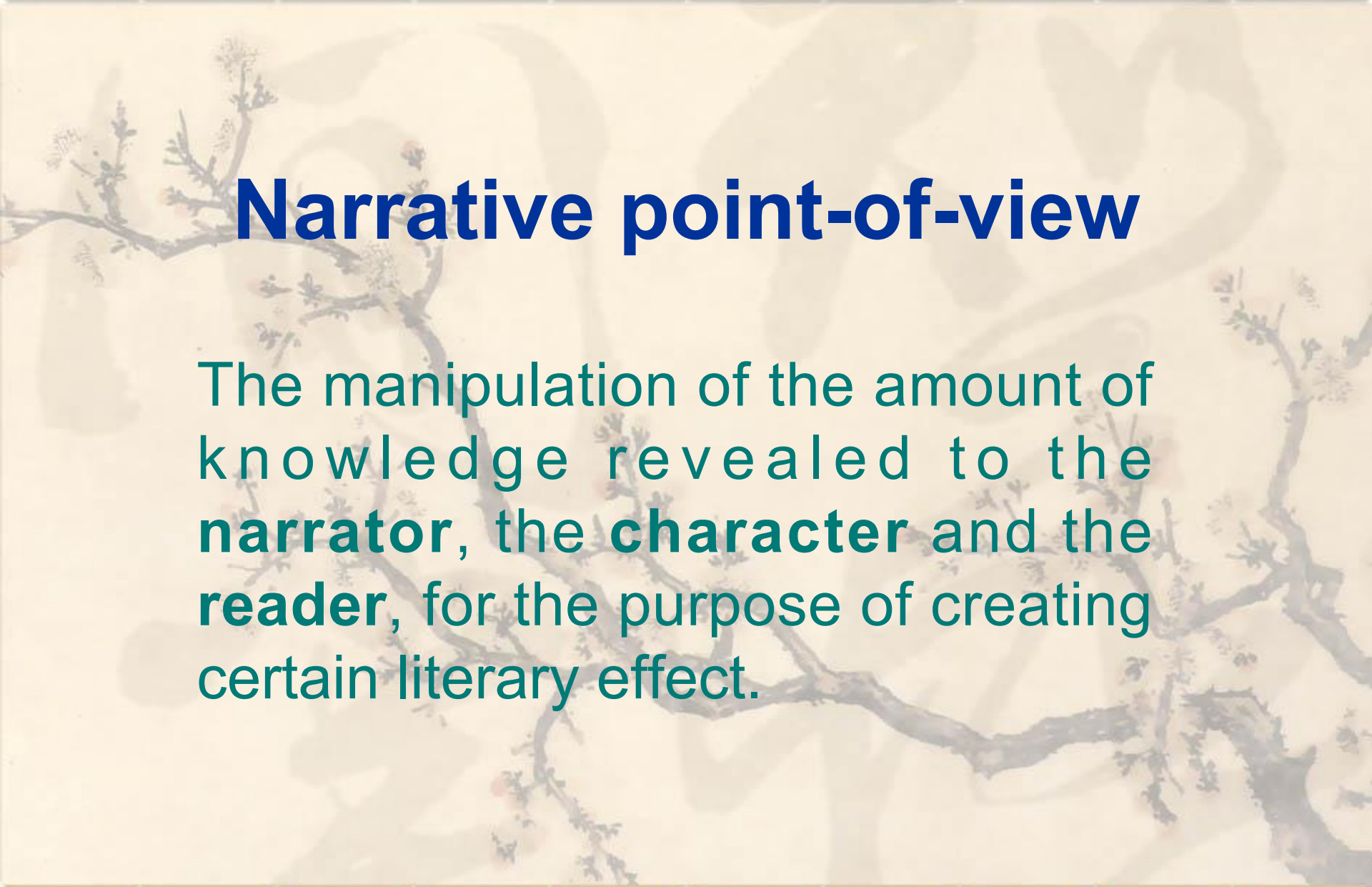
∞ **First person narrator:** narrator as a participant (I, me my, we, us, our)

∞ as protagonist

∞ as non-protagonist (foil)

❖ **Second person narrator:** narratee as a participant (you, your)

∞ **Third person narrator:** narrator is non-participant (he, she, they, or character's name)



Narrative point-of-view

The manipulation of the amount of knowledge revealed to the **narrator**, the **character** and the **reader**, for the purpose of creating certain literary effect.



Narrative Point-of-View 叙述视角 (1)

- ❖ 1. Cleanth Brooks & Robert Penn Warren (*Understanding Fiction* 《小说鉴赏》, 1938)
 - ❧ **First-person point of view** 第一人称视角
 - ❧ **Second-person point of view** 第二人称视角
 - ❧ **Third-person point of view** 第三人称视角
 - ❧ **Alternating (Multiple) person point of view** 变换人称视角

1. First-person narrator 第一人称叙述者 /First-person view 第一人称视角

- ❖ Narrator as the protagonist 第一人称自传性叙事角度 (1st person interior perspective)
 - ☞ e.g. Gulliver in *Gulliver's Travels*
- ❖ Narrator as someone close or as an ancillary character to the protagonist 第一人称观察者角度 (1st person exterior perspective)
 - ☞ Dr. Watson in *Sherlock Holmes*
 - ☞ Nick Carraway in *The Great Gatsby*

Third-Person Point of View

- ❖ Narrator usually isn't involved, but tells other's stories
- ❖ He, She, or character names
- ❖ 3 types of third-person narration: Depending on whether or how the narrator tells the thoughts and feelings of Characters
 - ❧ third-person omniscient (zero focalization)
 - ❧ third-person limited (interior focalization)
 - ❧ third-person objective (exterior focalization)

Third-Person Omniscient

第三人称全知视角

- ❖ Omni= All Scient=knowing
- ❖ Narrator is all knowing: Narrator can freely go into the mind and thoughts of **more than one character**.

e.g. Hardy's *Tess of the D'Urbervilles* , Leo Tolstoy's *Anna Karenina*

Popular among realistic writers in the Victorian age.

Third-Person Limited

第三人称有限视角

- ❖ Narrator is limited to **one character**.
- ❖ Narrator tells thoughts and feelings of this **one** character.
- ❖ e.g. Virginia Woolf's *To the Lighthouse* (stream of consciousness technique)

Third-Person Objective

第三人称客观视角

- ❖ Narrator does **not** reveal any of the character's thoughts or feelings.
- ❖ Only character's **dialogue** and **actions** are narrated.
 - ❧ *Hills Like White Elephants* by Ernest Hemingway

Narrative Tense 叙述时态

- ❖ Past tense
- ❖ Present tense
- ❖ Future tense

A Book List

- ❖ 《叙事学导论：从经典叙事学到后经典叙事学》 谭君强
- ❖ 《叙事学导论》 罗钢
- ❖ 《当说者被说的時候——比较叙述学导论》 赵毅衡
- ❖ 《西方叙事学》 申丹
- ❖ 《叙述学与小说文体学研究》 申丹
- ❖ Cleanth Brooks & Robert Penn Warren, *Understanding Fiction* (《小说鉴赏》)
- ❖ Ian Watt, *The Rise of the Novel: Studies in Defoe, Richardson and Fielding*, Berkeley: University of California Press, 1957. (《小说的兴起》)

Characterization 人物塑造 (p. 23)

- ❖ The term *characterization* was introduced in mid-19th century
 - ❧ Cf. Aristotle promoted the primacy of plot over characters:
 - ❖ Tragedy "is a representation, not of men, but of action and life." -- *Poetics*
- ❖ **character-driven literature**
 - ❧ Cf. **plot-driven literature**

- ❖ Characterization: the representation of a character, to establish each character as somewhat unique
- ❖ **Two types of character** (E.M. Foster in *Aspect of the Novel*):
 - ❧ **Round character:** well-developed, active, major character
 - ❧ **Flat character:** underdeveloped, static, minor character
- ❖ **Two ways of characterization:**
 - ❧ **Direct characterization:** the narrator or a character tells the reader another character's appearance or his or her personality
 - ❧ **indirect characterization:** narrators or characters describe what another character is like without comment.

Examples of Direct and Indirect characterization

- ❖ Mr. Bennet was so odd a mixture of quick parts, sarcastic humour, reserve, and caprice, that the experience of three and twenty years had been insufficient to make his wife understand his character. Her mind was less difficult to develop. She was a woman of mean understanding, little information, and uncertain temper. When she was discontented, she fancied herself nervous. The business of her life was to get her daughters married; its solace was visiting and news.



"What is his name?"

"Bingley."

"Is he married or single?"

"Oh! single, my dear, to be sure! A single man of large fortune; four or five thousand a year. What a fine thing for our girls!"

"How so? how can it affect them?"

"My dear Mr. Bennet," replied his wife, "how can you be so tiresome! You must know that I am thinking of his marrying one of them."

"Is that his design in settling here?"

"Design! nonsense, how can you talk so! But it is very likely that he may fall in love with one of them, and therefore you must visit him as soon as he comes."

"I see no occasion for that. You and the girls may go, or you may send them by themselves, which perhaps will be still better; for, as you are as handsome as any of them, Mr. Bingley might like you the best of the party."

"My dear, you flatter me. I certainly have had my share of beauty, but I do not pretend to be any thing extraordinary now. When a woman has five grown up daughters, she ought to give over thinking of her own beauty."



Style

❖ Style: the verbal identity of the work

❧ Diction

❧ Syntax

❧ Figure of speech

❧ Irony: ironic intention

❧ Symbol

General Questions for Study of Novels:

- ❖ What's the setting (time, place) of the story? Anything special about it?
- ❖ Who are the main characters? How are they related to each other?
- ❖ What is the thematic concern of the novel?
- ❖ From what point of view is the story told? How are the author, narrator, and the protagonist related to one another?

❖ What are the characteristics of writing?

- ❧ Is the vocabulary simple or complex? formal or colloquial? Are the nouns abstract or concrete? Are the adjectives frequent? Are verbs static or dynamic?
- ❧ Do sentences on the whole have a simple or a complex structure? What is the average sentence length (in number of words)?
- ❧ What are the figures of speech in the text if you can find any?
- ❧ What is the tone of narration?

The Egg (p.26)

Sherwood Anderson

- ❖ **Plot:** uneventful;
- ❖ **Characters and Characterization:** a character-driven novel
- ❖ **Symbol:** the egg; the grotesque chicken
- ❖ **Style:** colloquial, with a wry humor
- ❖ **Point of View:** first-person point of view with the narrator as non-protagonist, later part in the story, the narrative point of view turns to be a third-person omniscient narrator.

Analysis of the Plot

- ❖ **Plot:** uneventful (three unsuccessful ventures with eggs)
 - ❧ Chicken farm (to nurture eggs): the family's first venture to rise in the world
 - ❧ The restaurant (to serve eggs)
 - ❧ To entertain guests by using eggs as props
 - ❖ To make eggs stand on end
 - ❖ To show the guest the grotesque chicken
 - ❖ To play trick with egg
- ❖ **Climax:** when father tries desperately to entertain the customer
 - ❧ A detail description of father's speech, gesture and emotion;
 - ❧ A constant contrast of father and Joe Kane's behavior and reactions
(Pay attention to the point of view)

Characters and Characterization

❖ Characters

- ❧ Flat and static character: mother
- ❧ Round and active character (protagonist): father
- ❧ Antagonist: fate; the American passion (dream) for getting up in the world

❖ Characterization: a character-driven novel (direct or indirect characterization)

- ❧ Mother: appearance
- ❧ Father: appearance; action; speech; feeling; other's comments
- ❧ Son: thoughts, feeling

The Symbol of Egg

- ❖ Egg as the symbol of hope, and of the American dream.
- ❖ Egg as symbol of fragility: the fragility of human aspirations, innocence, and the inevitable "brokenness" of idealism in the face of reality. It is associated with failure and personal inadequacy.
- ❖ Egg is like fate: mysterious, uncooperative, unyielding to man's will, sometimes grotesque, playing tricks on men (The title of the short story collection: *The Triumph of the Egg*, 1921).
 - ∞ The cycle of egg-hen: the cycle of fate
- ❖ Egg is also like men, who are in the hand of fate: The unhappy fate awaiting the eggs resembles those awaiting human beings; a symbol of the futility of life itself ("Small chickens, just setting out on the journey of life, look so bright and alert and they are in fact so dreadfully stupid.")